

Wrath



A storm drops out of a wide sky toward one tree in an open field. Nothing stands between the weather and the tree.

Before you gather

- Read Day 7, Wrath, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Nahum 1:2–3, 7 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.

- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

When were you glad that someone in charge got angry at a real wrong?

Leader. Keep the stories short. You are showing that anger can be right before you open Nahum. Then let the text define God's wrath. Do not collect complaints. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: This storm is not God losing His temper. Wrath is His holy anger against sin, and the cross is the only shelter.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

The wrath of God is His holy revulsion against sin and His just judgment against sinners who rebel against His righteous standards.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek *orgē* — settled anger, righteous wrath, not a tantrum.

MEMORY VERSE · ROMANS 1:18

For the wrath of God is revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of men, who by their unrighteousness suppress the truth.

Together, open the flashcard for Wrath. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 · OPEN THE BIBLE · 15 MIN

Nahum 1:2–3, 7

Nahum holds wrath and refuge in one chapter. Stay here. Ask what the text says God is. Do not soften His anger into a mood. It is settled, holy opposition to sin. Do not reteach the journal.

The LORD is a jealous and avenging God; the LORD is avenging and wrathful; the LORD takes vengeance on his adversaries and keeps wrath for his enemies. The LORD is slow to anger and great in power, and the LORD will by no means clear the guilty. The LORD is good, a stronghold in the day of trouble; he knows those who take refuge in him.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. List what Nahum says God is against, and what He is for. Do not skip either list. **CORE**

Leader. He is jealous, avenging, and wrathful toward His adversaries. He is slow to anger and great in power, and He will by no means clear the guilty. He is also good, a stronghold for those who take refuge in Him. Both lists stand.

2. 'Slow to anger' and 'will by no means clear the guilty' sit side by side. What is lost if we keep only one line?

Leader. Only slow to anger: evil never matters. Only wrath: nobody can come home. Do not say love cancels God's anger. Nahum refuses that. The guilty are not cleared by niceness. Refuge is for those who come to Him.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. If God never grew angry at cruelty, what would that say about the people cruelty crushes?

Leader. A god who is never angry does not love the victim. Wrath is His holy revulsion against sin and His just judgment on rebels. God is not neutral. His anger is righteous.

4. Romans 1:18 says the wrath of God is revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of people who suppress the truth. Where do you see that already, without making a speech? **CORE**

Leader. Romans 1 names the fruit: truth pushed down, bodies used, lies treated as freedom. Wrath is present, not only future. Stay with the text. No partisan talk. The next sentence, if you speak of this outside, must be the cross.

5. How do we talk about God's wrath to a friend without sounding like we enjoy it? What must the next sentence be?

Leader. The next sentence is the cross. Jesus came to die. He was our substitute. He bore the wrath sinners deserve. If they cannot say that second sentence, they are not ready to say the first one in public.

5 · SAY IT · 5 MIN

In one sentence

God's wrath is His holy anger against sin, and Jesus bore it for all who trust Him.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 · THIS WEEK · 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Stand with someone who was harmed by a real wrong. Do not laugh it off or pile on. Then tell a friend that God's wrath is holy anger at sin, and

Jesus bore it for sinners who trust Him.

Leader. Keep this off political speeches and off gloating. We stand under the same wrath. The sentence must land on the substitute, not on a villain we enjoy. Words and actions. Both. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 • PRAY • 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Lord, You are slow to anger, and You will not clear the guilty. We praise Your holiness.
2. Forgive us if we have enjoyed the thought of someone else under the storm.
3. Make us truthful and tender, and help us say that Jesus bore wrath for sinners.

Before you stumble

Two failures: mocking people who struggle with wrath, and gloating as if we were the lightning. Correct both. If someone says God's love cancels His anger, do not leave it. Read Nahum 1:2-3 again. Love does not clear the guilty. The cross does, because the Son was condemned in our place. Do not camp on graphic pictures of hell. Camp in Nahum: He will not clear the guilty, and He is a stronghold.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask what kind of god they would want if someone hurt their brother or sister. Most will want a God who gets angry. Then ask if they want that same God reading their phones. Read Nahum 1:7. Refuge is for those who come to Him.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Psalm 7:11-12. God is a righteous judge, and He is indignant every day. If a person does not turn, He prepares His weapons. Wrath does not mean there is no warning. Repentance is still commanded.